United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

Intangible Cultural Heritage

Raising awareness

Unit 5 PowerPoint presentation

UNESCO
Intangible Cultural Heritage Section

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In this presentation …

Awareness raising:

- What is it?
- Why is it needed?
- Awareness about what?
- How can awareness be raised?
- By whom?
- Whose awareness is raised?
- Use of the emblem of the Convention
- Avoiding negative consequences

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Awareness for safeguarding

Preamble:

- Awareness of the importance of safeguarding ICH

Article 1 – Purposes of the Convention:

- Safeguarding the ICH
- Respect for the ICH
- Awareness of the importance of ICH
- International cooperation and assistance

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Recognition, respect, enhancement

Article 14

Each State Party shall endeavour, by all appropriate means, to: (a) ensure recognition of, respect for, and enhancement of the intangible cultural heritage in society, in particular through: (i) educational, awareness-raising and information programmes, aimed at the general public, in particular young people ...

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Awareness about what?

- The existence and diversity of ICH
- The value and function of ICH
- The role of communities concerned
- Threats or risks to viability
- Possible safeguarding actions/good practices
- The Convention, inscribed elements and good practices

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Amul Surabhi TV series and Surabhi Foundation (India)

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Ways to raise awareness

- Radio, television, websites
- Educational programmes
- Networks, meetings and seminars for targeted groups
- Festivals and events
- Commercial activities (e.g. tourism)
- Inventories
- Lists and Register of the Convention
- ICH policies

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Who raises whose awareness?

- The Committee and Secretariat
- States Parties
- The media
- Institutions and organizations, including NGOs
- Communities, groups and individuals concerned, and their organizations

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ROLE OF THE COMMITTEE

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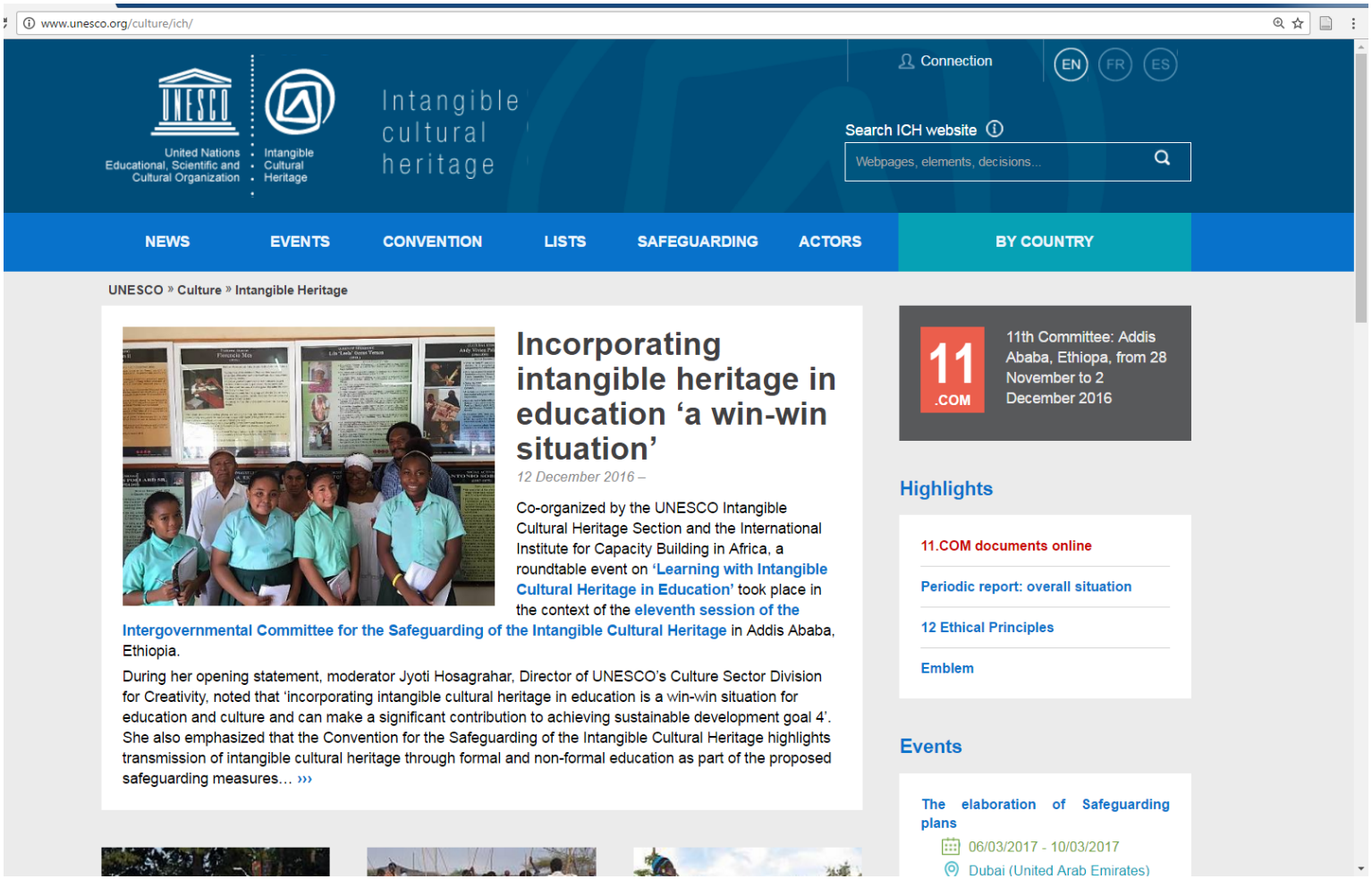
UNESCO ICH website



http://www.unesco.org/culture/ich/

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ROLE OF STATES PARTIES

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Awareness-raising activities in Colombia

The Carnival of Barranquilla, Colombia
© Ministerio de la Cultura, Colombia
Inscribed on the RL in 2008

Every year during the four days before Lent, the Carnival de Barranquilla offers a repertory of dances and musical expressions originating from different Colombian sub-cultures.

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ROLE OF THE MEDIA

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BBC TV series: *Mastercrafts*

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ROLE OF INSTITUTIONS AND ORGANIZATIONS

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Example: Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (India)

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ROLE OF COMMUNITIES

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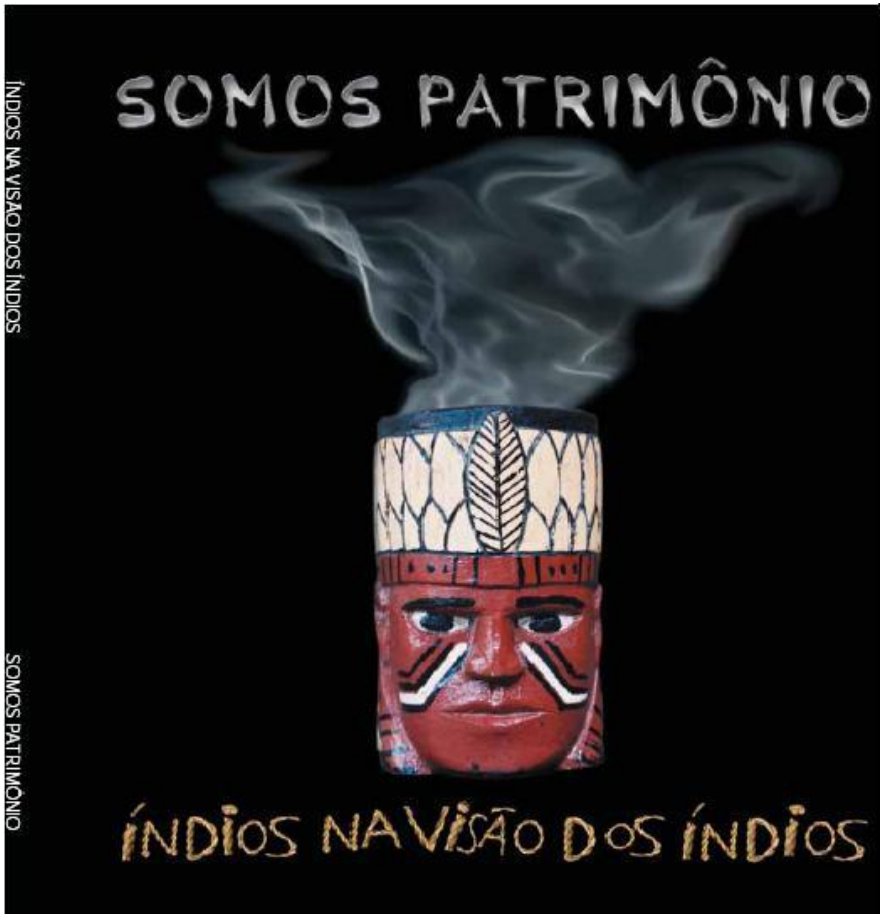
‘Indians as seen by Indians’ project (Brazil)



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Emblem of the Convention

- Only to be used with the UNESCO logo (OD 125)
- Use subject to rules and authorization (OD 128)
- Preferably associated with practices and events
- Commercial use possible under strict conditions

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Avoiding negative consequences

- Community involvement
- Community consent
- Appropriate access
- Mutual respect
- Protecting viability
- Fair representation
- Fair benefit

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Maintain the context

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All parties are encouraged to take particular care to ensure that awareness-raising actions will not:

de-contextualize or denaturalize the intangible cultural heritage manifestations or expressions concerned (OD 102(a))

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Do not stereotype communities

© Juanita Escobar, 2008

All parties are encouraged to take particular care to ensure that awareness-raising actions will not:

mark the communities, groups or individuals concerned as not participating in contemporary life, or harm in any way their image (OD 102(b))

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Do not misappropriate or abuse

All parties are encouraged to take particular care to ensure that awareness-raising actions will not:

facilitate the misappropriation or abuse of the knowledge and skills of the communities, groups or individuals concerned (OD 102(d))

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Avoid over-commercialization

© 2012 by Murshid Anwar

All parties are encouraged to take particular care to ensure that awareness-raising actions will not:

lead to over-commercialization or to unsustainable tourism that may put at risk the intangible cultural heritage concerned (OD 102(e))

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Published in 2016 by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, 7, place de Fontenoy, 75352 Paris 07 SP, France

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